

Project Charter

Meridian Group Data Platform Consolidation

Meridian Group is made up of three operating entities — Meridian North, Meridian West, and Meridian Coastal — and each one runs its own vendor list, invoice tracking, and bank reconciliation out of a separate spreadsheet. There has never been a shared vendor master between them. The same vendor can show up under three different local IDs, and the active/inactive flag often disagrees depending on which entity's sheet you happen to be looking at.

That's the problem this project set out to fix. Reconciliation was taking 46 days on average before a bank transaction got confirmed against its invoice. Vendor payment turnaround was sitting around 43 days despite most vendors carrying 30-day terms or shorter, largely because setup problems — a missing tax ID, terms nobody had actually confirmed, a status that didn't match across entities — weren't caught until an invoice was already stuck in the payment queue. Roughly one invoice in five had some kind of data-quality issue, usually a duplicate entry or a missing PO reference. And there was no consolidated view of any of this: anyone who wanted a cross-entity picture had to build it by hand from three spreadsheets.

Objectives

- 1 Migrate vendor, invoice, and bank transaction data from all three entities into one platform, resolving duplicate vendor records in the process.
- 2 Move reconciliation from manual line-matching to an exception-based process, so only unmatched items or amount variances need a person's attention.
- 3 Put a validation step in front of vendor setup so a bad record gets caught before it reaches the payment queue instead of after.
- 4 Build a KPI view that shows reconciliation health, payment turnaround, and backlog trend without someone manually rolling up three spreadsheets every time leadership asks for an update.

Scope

In scope: vendor master data, invoice data, bank transaction data, the reconciliation process, the vendor setup process, and the reporting layer on top of all of it.

Out of scope: general ledger and chart-of-accounts work, payroll, HR systems, and anything tenant- or customer-facing.

Roles

Role	Responsibility
Business Systems Analyst	Requirements, data migration, automation, reporting, and documentation for this project end to end.

Role	Responsibility
Entity finance leads (3)	Validate their own source data, sign off on migrated records, participate in UAT.
Leadership sponsor	Prioritization and go-live approval.

Success criteria

Whether this worked comes down to four numbers, pulled straight from the migrated data rather than estimated after the fact: average reconciliation cycle time, average vendor payment turnaround, invoice error rate, and the trend of the open backlog after go-live. All four are on the dashboard.

Timeline

Phase	Milestone
Jan – Jun 2025	Baseline period under the legacy process
Jun 2025	Migration, cleansing, UAT
Jul 1, 2025	Go-live
Jul – Dec 2025	New process in production